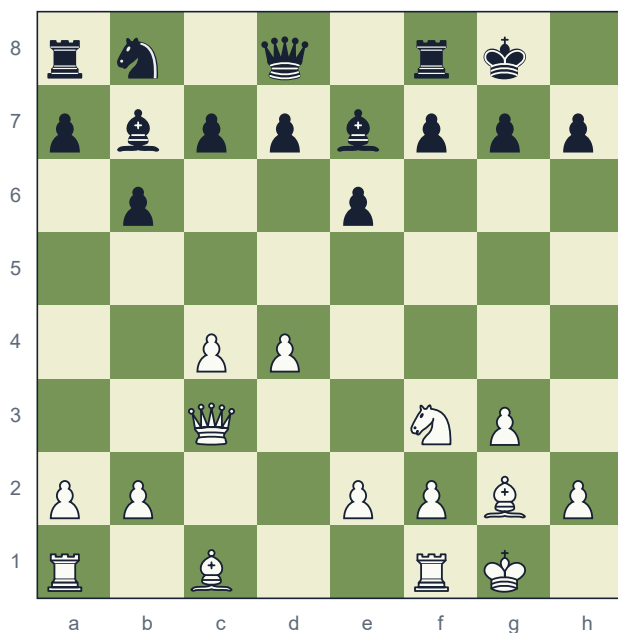


# Queen's Indian: the g3 repertoire

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 b6 4.g3

## YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Fianchetto the king bishop and support the center with pieces. Learn distinct answers to ...Bb7 and ...Ba6 rather than treating them as interchangeable.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

## THE PAWN STRUCTURE

Black controls e4 with Nf6 and a queenside bishop. White seeks stable d4-c4 space and a timely e4 or d5 break without weakening the long diagonals.

## WHAT BLACK WANTS

...Ba6 attacks c4; ...Bb7 pressures e4. Black may choose ...d5, ...c5 or a hedgehog-like setup with ...d6.

## THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Against ...Ba6, defend c4 before carrying on with a routine fianchetto.
2. Do not push e4 until it is adequately supported against both the knight and the bishop.
3. The move b3 can defend c4 but also invites checks on b4; learn the complete response.

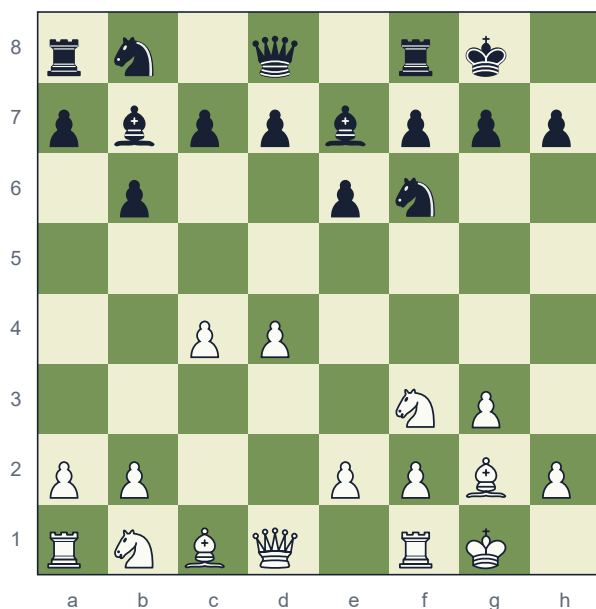
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

# 01 Classical ...Bb7 setup

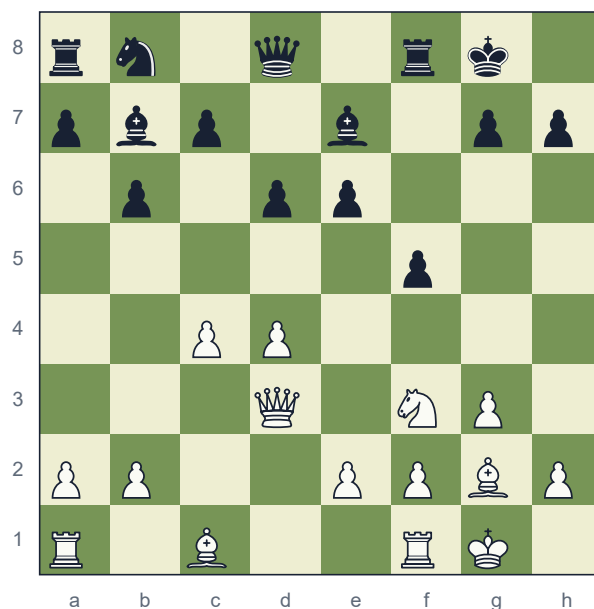
## STUDY LINE 11-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. Nc3 Ne4 8. Qc2 Nxc3 9. Qxc3 d6 10. Qd3 f5

Selected anchor ends with 9. Qxc3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

## WHY THESE MOVES

Qc2 supports central play and the queen recapture preserves your pawns. Black exchanges a useful knight but reduces White's control of e4.

## YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the c1 bishop to f4 or g5 when appropriate. Prepare e4 or d5 only after checking the long diagonal.

## WATCH FOR

The b7 bishop can suddenly attack g2 after central exchanges.

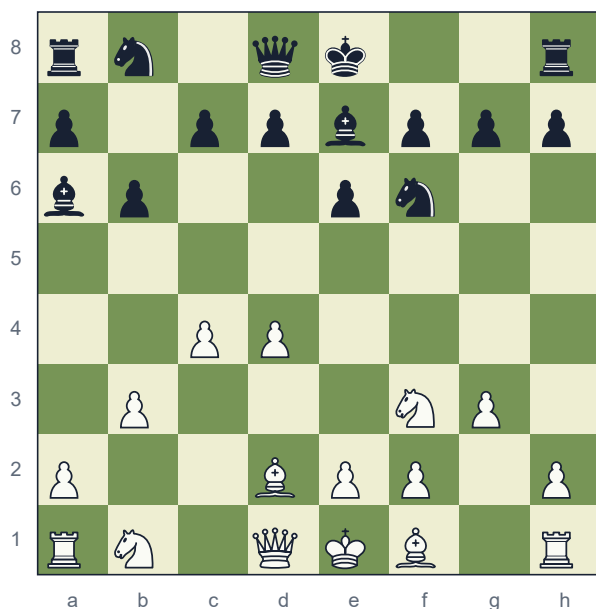
**REMEMBER** Coordinate the center before opening the long diagonal.

## 02 ...Ba6 and the standard b3 defense

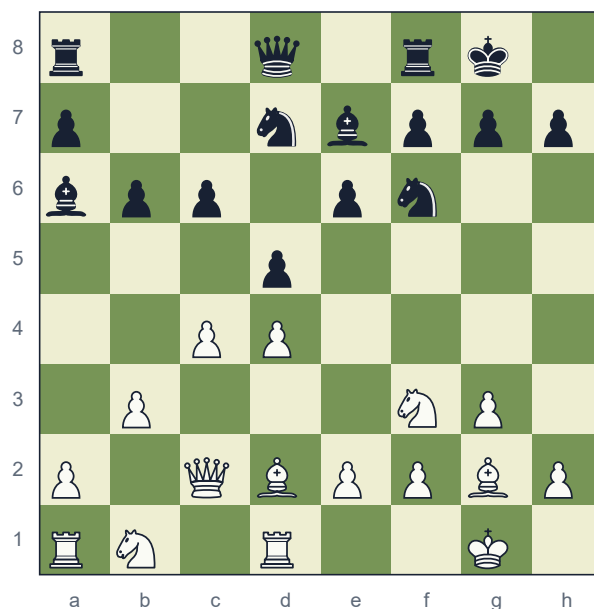
### STUDY LINE 11-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7 7. Bg2 c6 8. O-O d5 9. Qc2 O-O 10. Rd1 Nbd7

Selected anchor ends with 8... d5. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

### WHY THESE MOVES

b3 defends c4. Bd2 interposes against the check and makes ...Bb4+ a manageable part of the move order.

### YOUR NEXT PLAN

Qc2 and development of the b1 knight complete the setup. Compare cxd5 with maintaining tension when Black plays ...d5.

### WATCH FOR

The queen bishop's placement on d2 may affect whether Nc3 is tactically safe.

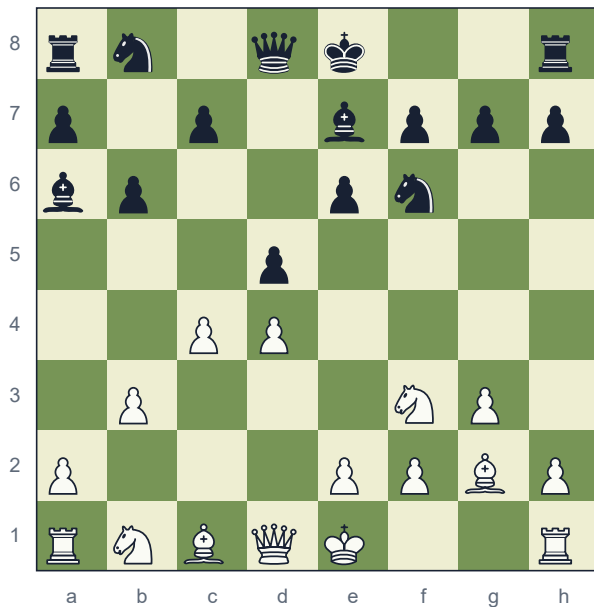
**REMEMBER** Defend c4, answer the check, then finish the fianchetto.

## 03 ...Ba6 without the check

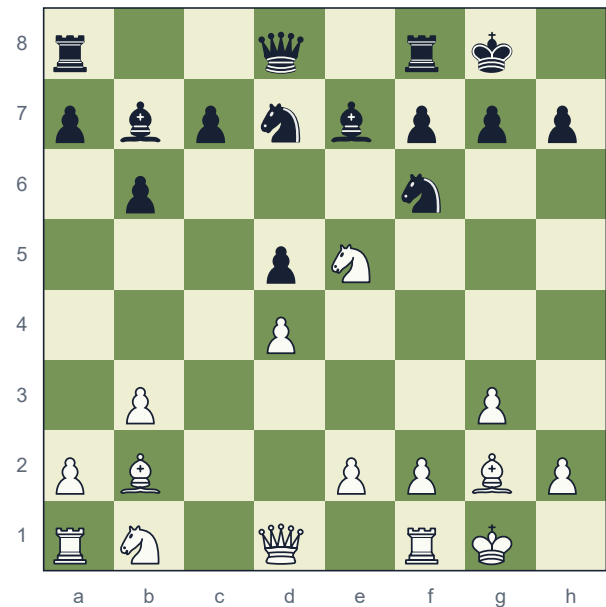
### STUDY LINE 11-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 d5 6. Bg2 Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Ne5 Bb7 10. Bb2 Nbd7

Selected anchor ends with 7... O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

### WHY THESE MOVES

With no check, White can complete normal kingside development. The a6 bishop still influences decisions about c4 and the f1-a6 diagonal.

### YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop Bb2 or a knight as the position allows. Do not release the central tension without identifying the better recapture.

### WATCH FOR

A capture on d5 may activate Black's pieces and surrender the space advantage.

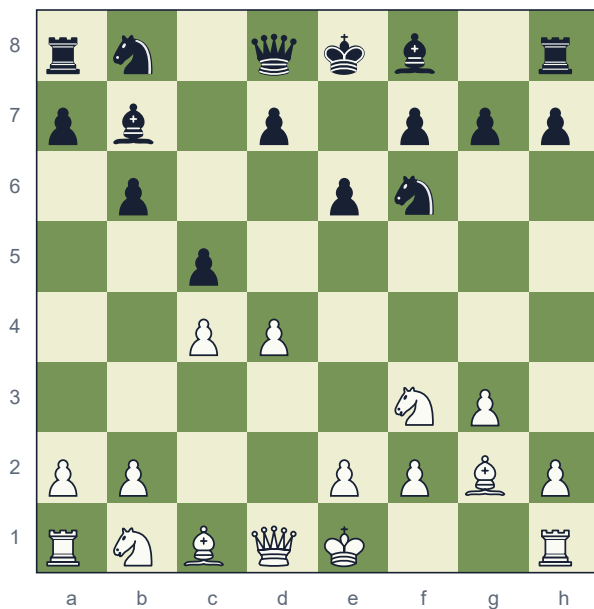
**REMEMBER** Keep c4 defended while coordinating both wings.

## 04 The early ...c5 structure

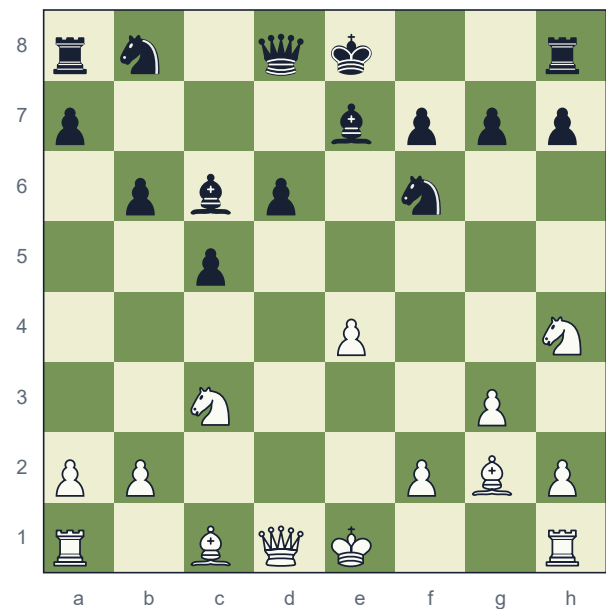
### STUDY LINE 11-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 c5 6. d5 exd5 7. cxd5 Bxd5 8. Nc3 Bc6 9. e4 d6 10. Nh4 Be7

Selected anchor ends with 6. d5. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 5 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

### WHY THESE MOVES

d5 gains space while Black's bishop has committed to b7. Exchanges can produce a Benoni-like structure.

### YOUR NEXT PLAN

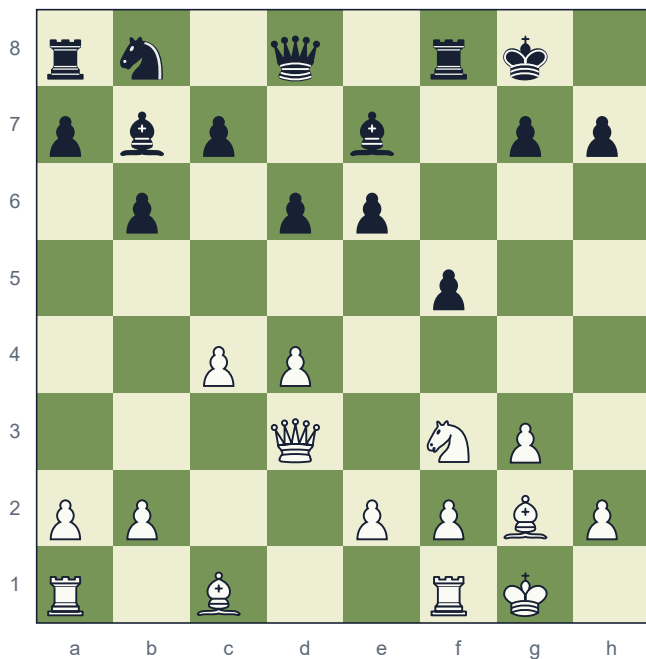
If ...exd5, recapture with the c-pawn and compare the resulting center with the Benoni booklet. Develop before attacking the queenside.

### WATCH FOR

Do not recapture with a piece by reflex; the choice determines whether you keep a space-gaining pawn on d5.

**REMEMBER** The center decides which opening family you now have.

# Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

## 1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

Black controls e4 with Nf6 and a queenside bishop. White seeks stable d4-c4 space and a timely e4 or d5 break without weakening the long diagonals.

## 2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

...Ba6 attacks c4; ...Bb7 pressures e4. Black may choose ...d5, ...c5 or a hedgehog-like setup with ...d6.

## 3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Develop the c1 bishop to f4 or g5 when appropriate. Prepare e4 or d5 only after checking the long diagonal.

## RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

## DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

## SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.